

Benefits Comparison by Country 2025

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1. Purpose

This document compares the core benefits Meridian Instruments provides at its four sites: Leeds (UK), Rotterdam (NL), Austin (US) and Penang (MY). Benefits are designed locally to fit each country's statutory system, so they are not identical. The detailed rules are in each country's guide; where this summary and a country guide differ, the country guide applies.

2. Core benefits

Benefit | UK | NL | US | MY

Employer pension | up to 8% | 8% | up to 5% match | 16% EPF

Employee pension | 3% minimum | 4% | 4% auto-enrol | 11% EPF

Life cover | 4x salary | 3x salary | 2x salary (max \$500,000) | 36 months salary

Medical | PMI employee only | €40/month contribution | 85% employee premium, 70% dependants |

GHS plus RM 1,500 GP

Dental | Flex option | Flex option | Company plan | Panel clinics

Income protection | 75% after 26 weeks | Statutory + top-up | 60% after 90 days | n/a

Wellbeing allowance | £250 | €300 | \$350 | RM 1,000

Employee Assistance Programme | Yes | Yes | Yes | Yes

3. Notes by benefit

Pension

- UK: Meridian Group Personal Pension with a matched structure; see the UK Pension Scheme Guide.
- NL: Zeevaart Pensioen defined contribution scheme; see the Netherlands Pension and 30% Ruling FAQ.
- US: Meridian 401(k) plan with company match; see the US 401(k) Retirement Plan Guide.
- MY: Employees Provident Fund with a Meridian top-up; see the Malaysia Statutory Contributions and Medical Benefits Guide.

Life cover

Life cover is provided from the first day of employment at no cost to the employee. US life cover above \$50,000 is a taxable benefit (imputed income). In Malaysia, cover is 36 months of basic salary.

Medical

- UK: private medical insurance covers the employee only; partners and children can be added at the employee's own cost through flexible benefits.
- NL: Dutch basic health insurance is compulsory and arranged by each employee; Meridian pays a fixed contribution of €40 per month through payroll.
- US: Meridian pays 85% of the employee-only premium and 70% of the premium for dependants on the PPO or HDHP plan.
- MY: group hospitalisation and surgical (GHS) insurance plus outpatient GP visits at panel clinics up to RM 1,500 per year.

Income protection

UK income protection pays 75% of salary after 26 weeks of absence. NL employees receive statutory sick pay during the first two years with a Meridian top-up as described in the

Sickness Absence Policy (POL-HR-017). US long-term disability pays 60% of salary after 90 days. There is no separate income protection plan in Malaysia; SOCSO invalidity benefits apply.

Wellbeing allowance

The wellbeing allowance is paid once per financial year and can be claimed in Atlas against receipts for fitness classes, sports equipment, mindfulness apps and similar items. Unused allowance does not carry over. It is separate from the one-off home office allowance in the Remote and Hybrid Working Policy (POL-HR-022).

4. Enrolment and changes

Benefit enrolment and changes are made in Keel > Benefits > Enrol. UK flexible benefits choices are made in the annual March window described in the Flexible Benefits Enrolment FAQ 2025 (UK). Questions go to benefits@meridian-instruments.example.